Evidence about Rosa Parks

Friday 29 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | GROW | Spring 1 Week 4 | HUM-GROW-S1-W04

A–F are new factual teaching summaries, written in 2026. No old text, speech, testimony or picture is copied. They describe the past; our scores are reasoned views about it.

A Work before the bus protest

1943–1955

In 1943, Rosa Parks became secretary of a local civil rights group. She helped record unfair treatment and worked for equal rights. Her work began years before her bus arrest.

Research basis: H1, H3.

B A refusal and arrest

1 December 1955

In Montgomery, racist bus rules kept Black and White people apart. On 1 December 1955, Parks refused to give up her seat. Police arrested her. Local groups then called for a bus boycott on 5 December.

Research basis: H1, H2.

Which test could this fact help? Why? What can it not show?

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C A protest kept going by many

5 December 1955–20 December 1956

Many Black residents stayed off Montgomery buses. People walked, shared rides and raised funds. Local organisers helped the protest last. Parks's action mattered within this joint work. One person could not keep it going alone.

Research basis: H2, H5.

D A separate case changed bus law

1956

The court case Browder v. Gayle challenged bus segregation. Parks was not one of its plaintiffs. Judges ruled against the bus rules. After the court order arrived, the boycott ended. People returned to integrated buses on 21 December 1956.

Research basis: H2, H5, H6.

Which test could this fact help? Why? What can it not show?

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E Work continued in Detroit

1965–1988

Parks later lived in Detroit. From 1965 to 1988 she worked in a member of Congress's local office. She helped people with their needs and kept working for civil rights. Her public work reached beyond one bus journey.

Research basis: H1, H3.

F Public honours and remembrance

1999 and 2013

Parks received a gold medal from Congress in 1999. A statue of her was placed in the US Capitol in 2013, after her death in 2005. These are signs of wide public remembrance.

Research basis: H1, H3.

Which test could this fact help? Why? What can it not show?